

```
kailas@Kailas:~$ df
Filesystem            1K-blocks      Used Available Use% Mounted on
/dev/hda1             37752556    1707872    34126928   5% /
tmpfs                 124432         0     124432    0% /dev/shm
tmpfs                 124432     12588     111844   11% /lib/modules/2.6.12-9-386/volatile
kailas@Kailas:~$
```

The result of the `df` command

how much free space is available in each partition. You can delete the contents of the `/tmp` directory. Login as root if need be. Files that are in use will not get deleted, so don't worry about deleting anything important.

Another place you can look for dead files is the `/var/tmp` directory. Logs and spools will be stored here, and might not have been deleted during a sudden termination.

3.2.1 The file system and disk maintenance

As the name suggests, the file system is the method by which files are stored on storage devices (hard disk, CD-ROM, etc.). As all files are invariably stored on the media, it makes sense to ensure that there are no errors on your hard disk or in the file system itself. If your hard disk crashes, then recovery, if at all possible, will be a tough job. Sometimes hard disks give a warning before they die—unusual screeching noises or bad sectors. Here are some operations—commands that look for errors, or just change hard disk parameters:

Check For Bad Sectors (blocks): `badblocks`

The command `"badblocks /dev/had"` will search the first partition of the first IDE hard drive for badblocks. Similarly, to check for bad blocks in the second, third, fourth IDE hard drive, replace `"hda"` with `hdb`, `hdc` or `hdd` respectively.

3.2.1.1 Change partitions, format, view partition info

`cfdisk` is a partition table manipulator used to create or delete partitions. As you open `cfdisk`, you will see a bounty of options at the bottom of the screen. Browse through them, but do not make any changes unless you are absolutely sure of what you're doing! This